

# KF26 Meeting Version of Teachings

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Karis is an invitation to a relationship based on mutual generosity.

“Search me, O God, and know my heart. Examine me and know my thoughts. See if there is any way in me that causes pain, and lead me in the ways of eternity.” (Psalm 139:23–24)

**0:01    OPENING**

**0:02    PRESENTING**

**0:06    KARIS CIRCULATION**

**0:07    GUIDELINES & LIMITATIONS**

**0:08    MINDFULNESS & MEDITATION TRAINING**

A well-known body bio-mechanics expert said that *the most important piece of restoring function starts with creating space in your day to heal.*<sup>1</sup> (Repeat) Karis Fellowships meetings are a healing space, and so is your meditation practice.

A KF member wrote about the stages on his journey as he worked toward a satisfying meditation practice. This is what he said:

“My first thought was—I should meditate, but I can’t do it. After a while I learned that it is a challenge to meditate—I will try to do it. I did that for a few weeks, and I realized that meditation helps me—I see value in doing it. Then, with amazement, I was able to see that I need to meditate—I am changed by doing it. After several months I thought I want to meditate—I like to do it. Near the end of the KF training, I understood that meditation is an adventure and wondered what is possible if I continue to do this?”

Let’s continue to practice **Centering Prayer**.<sup>2</sup>

Take a meditation posture. You might try standing during this exercise and see if that works for you. Begin with silent prayer, resting in the spirit and the breath. (*Pause for 30 seconds*)

Ask God for a *word*, and allow that word, phrase, or image to rest in your mind. (*Pause for 30 seconds*)

Stick to this word during your meditation time. When other thoughts intrude, gently return to your word. Try practicing the balanced breath, using equal amounts of time to inhale and exhale. (*Pause for 30 seconds*)

When you are ready, allow the word to float away, and then rest in the stillness of your mind. You might try saying or attending to the word for one breath and then resting in the stillness for two breaths. Breathe. (*Pause for 1 minute*)

And now, practice resting only in the stillness, the quiet mind, for one minute. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

Pause. Take a full deep breath, as if you were stretching your insides. Gently re-engage with the meeting.

Our scripture for this meditation is Psalm 27:14.

Wait on the Lord;  
Be of good courage,  
And allow your heart to be strengthened.  
Yes, wait on the Lord.

Take a deep breath.

*(Go immediately to the Confession to allow time for the Toolbox)*

## **0:20 KARIS CONFESSION**

## **0:21 TOOLBOX**

The world is mesmerized by appearance, talent, and money. In KF, we call these attributes the *ATM*. With the same effortless ease that cash can be withdrawn from a machine, people draw on their assets of appearance, talent, and money to create an illusion of superiority and to feed the Idol's search for glory. We are all encouraged by our culture to buy into the illusions of the ATM and may therefore feel fear or show deference when a person with a big ATM balance comes into the room. This is called *partiality*.

It is not only the appearance of wealth that clouds our ability to make principled decisions. The appearance of poverty can also interfere with our ability to maintain orientation. Our culture often pressures us to show partiality toward people who appear to be in need. However, these people may be projecting a small ATM to create the illusion of helplessness.

Like someone who has a stash of money but acts as if they have none, a person can give the appearance of being more disadvantaged and less capable than they actually are. These people use the illusion of their poverty to steal from the community.<sup>3</sup> Others use their real poverty to manipulate the community into taking care of them and to avoid taking responsibility for their own lives. Their poverty then supports their pride system and gives them an illusion of power.

The ethos of Karis Fellowships is very different from the culture of our market economy, which is based on contracts and the ATM. Our ministry simply aspires to empower all Christians who want to recover their True Self for the glory of God. KF is not a need-based ministry; it is *effort-based*. This is extremely important. It is the effort you make to recover your True Self and build karis relationships that reveals your true intention. Your ATM balance is not important in the karis economy; it is your effort, not your need or your wealth, that invites support and care from other KF members. We gain strength through fellowship with others as together we stagger toward the goal of developing a strong and resilient True Self. We invest in effort-based people so that when our True Self starts to run, we can run with those who are also running. This is a new kind of race in which we all start weak but end strong.

We will now use the **T-A-T** to explore the issue of money.<sup>4</sup> In this training session we will spend one minute on each step. Feel free to continue holding the pose rather than writing down your thoughts. Just do whatever is most helpful for you.

## The T-A-T

Let's begin. Take the pose, and breathe.

### 1. Choose an issue or problem. *(Pause) (Repeat the instruction)*

During this first step, imagine a problem, a craving, or any illusion you might have about money. If you can, experience in your body the sensations associated with money, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Pause. On a scale of one to ten, rate the intensity of the craving, discomfort, or resistance you might feel about confronting this problem. Very uncomfortable feelings would rate as a ten. Jot down a few words that will help you remember what you thought and felt about the problem. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Take the pose again, and breathe.

### 2. Imagine how you would think and feel, and what your life would be like, if you did not have this problem or illusion about money. *(Pause for 15 seconds) (Repeat the instruction) (Pause for 15 seconds)*

Pause. You might wish to jot down a few notes. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Take the pose again, and breathe.

### 3. Listen to the clearing statement: *"God, thank You for healing the origins of this problem."* *(Pause for 15 seconds)* *"The origins of this problem are healing now."* *(Pause for 15 seconds)*

Pause, and if you wish, jot down your feelings or thoughts. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Take the pose again, and breathe deeply.

### 4. Listen to the clearing statement: *"God, thank You for healing all the areas of my life, mind, and body that are misoriented by this problem."* *(Pause for 15 seconds)* *"All the areas of my life, mind, and body that are misoriented by this problem are healing now."* *(Pause for 15 seconds)*

Pause. If you have any thoughts or feelings about that, write them down now. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Take the pose again, and breathe.

### 5. Listen to the clearing statement: *"God, thank You for healing all the places in me that get something out of holding on to this problem."* *(Pause for 15 seconds)* *"All the places in me that get something out of holding on to this problem are healing now."* *(Pause for 15 seconds)*

Pause. If you have any thoughts or feelings, you might write them down now. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Take the pose, and breathe deeply.

The next step leads us into forgiveness. The Greek word often translated as *forgive* means to *release from debt*.

6. **Listen to the clearing statement:** *“I forgive everyone and everything, including God and myself, that I have blamed for this problem.”* Breathe, and on the exhale, let go. *(Pause for 15 seconds)* *“I release everyone and everything that I have held responsible for this problem.”* Breathe, and on the exhale, let go. *(Pause for 15 seconds)*

Pause. Write down your thoughts. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

And now, for the final step, take the pose and breathe.

7. **Listen to the clearing statement:** *“I ask forgiveness from everyone and everything that I have damaged by holding on to this problem, including God’s purposes and my True Self.”* Breathe. *(Pause for 15 seconds)* *“I accept responsibility for the damage that I have caused to anyone or anything by holding on to this problem.”* Breathe. *(Pause for 15 seconds)*

Pause. Make a note of any thoughts you might have. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Write down how you now feel about the problem. On a scale of one to ten, how would you rate the intensity of your discomfort? *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

And pause. As homework, you might practice using this tool again, focusing on the same problem while holding the pose and breathing for two minutes at each step. Evaluate the difference between using the shorter and the longer **T-A-T**.

Our prayer might go something like this:

*Father of Lights, help me be responsible with the good gift of money.<sup>5</sup> (Repeat)*

Take a deep breath.

*(If time permits, ask, “Does anyone have comments or questions about the Toolbox?”)*

## **0:30 SHARING**

*(If the meeting is running behind, divide the group into small subgroups so that you can move through the Sharing quickly and get back in sync with the Meeting Schedule)*

## **1:00 BIBLE TEACHING**

KF Confession 6 reminds us of how much energy we have wasted in misoriented living.

We chose to foster illusions to save the life of our Idol Self.

In the last lesson, we talked about how to use our very human gift of imagination in a healthy way. When we have a misoriented response to the ATM, a well-trained imagination can help set us on the Believe It Path. We can learn to appreciate the ATM without judging ourselves or others. Once we are free from the constraining preoccupation with appearances, talent, and money, we can make choices that create oriented outcomes that declare the glory of God.

How people feel about money and how they handle money is often a real puzzle. Just like energy, the flow of money becomes distorted and is aimlessly dissipated when it passes through misoriented hands. Let's see what James says about the ATM. This is Nancy's paraphrase of **James 2:1–17**.

<sup>1</sup>My siblings, do not abuse the trust of our Lord Jesus Christ—who is committed to real glory—by showing favoritism to others because of the false glory of material appearances. <sup>2</sup>Here is an example: If a gold-ringed man comes into your synagogue in splendid, bright clothing and, also, a beggar enters in filthy clothing, <sup>3</sup>and you gaze upon the one wearing the radiant clothes and say, “You sit here in the good place, a good place that carries with it the symbol of achieved virtue,” and then you say to the beggar, “You stand over there away from me because to be associated with you is social suicide,” or, perhaps, “Sit below my footstool to show that I am superior to you,” <sup>4</sup>are you not distinguishing the rich man from the beggar by your choices and becoming judges using worthless and malicious calculations? <sup>5</sup>Listen, my beloved siblings. Did not God choose the beggars of the world to be rich in trusting God and to be heirs of the kingdom which He promised to anyone who loves Him? <sup>6</sup>But you have judged the beggar to be unworthy based solely on his poverty. Are not the rich gaining control over you and dragging you into court where people are judged by man-made laws, not by God's laws? <sup>7</sup>You put the rich in a seat of virtue, yet do they not vilify and defame the virtuous name of Jesus for which you all have been summoned as witnesses? <sup>8</sup>If, however, you are fulfilling the kingdom law according to the Scripture “Love your neighbor as yourself”, you are a doer of virtue. Doing virtue looks like this: If you are giving up the good place to a rich person of real virtue because he is your neighbor in a karis relationship, you are creating more virtue and orientation. <sup>9</sup>But if you are simply showing partiality based on outward appearances, you are working at misorientation and are in error, and under the kingdom law of God your choices are evidence that you have missed your way.

Take a deep breath.

In this passage, James compares real glory with appearances. Real glory is virtuous action, whereas false glory can be cheaply attributed to others based on no action at all. That is called *partiality*: offering honor to someone who has done nothing to deserve it. We see how the ATM—appearance, talent, and money—can make us partial to those whose actions reveal no evidence of real virtue.

Let's skip down a bit in this same chapter to where James talks about faith, or trust, and real virtue.

<sup>14</sup>What use is it, my siblings, if someone says that he trusts God but makes no effort to contribute to the community? Can that trust save him? <sup>15</sup>If a brother or sister is without clothing and in need of daily food, <sup>16</sup>and one of you says to them, “Go in peace, be warmed and be filled,” and yet you do not give them what is necessary for their body, what use is that? <sup>17</sup>Even so, faith or trust, if we make no effort to help, is dead, being only words and illusions.

Take a deep breath.

If we are deluded enough to trust money more than we trust God, we will feel insecure whether we have money or not. We will therefore create virtue stories that justify our hoarding and will reckon as virtue

generous intentions that never translate into substantial action. Every kind of hoarding and greed stifles the karis economy within our community.

When we claim to trust God but refuse to act on that trust, we are living in an illusion. James is telling us a simple truth: *Only action is action (Repeat)*, and our action reveals the quality of our faith, or trust. God is not telling us to give to every poor person or to every cause. He is telling us to support the community of spiritually committed brothers and sisters with whom we experience various levels of karis relationship. These are the people who show by their choices that they trust God and are making real efforts to grow into the possibilities of that trust.

Our prayer might go something like this.

*Lord, teach me to take real action that reveals the quality of my trust in You. (Repeat)*

Take a deep breath.

*(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the Bible teaching?")*

## **1:10 INTEGRATION**

Sip some purified water and prepare to take some notes. Assume a meditation posture, and breathe. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

Here is our integration focus: *Consider revealing what you believe through your actions. (Repeat) (Pause for 30 seconds)*

## **The FAITH Process**

### **Feelings**

As you *consider revealing what you believe through your actions*, breathe and recognize any feelings or any resistance that may be present. *(Pause)* Just observe your experience with compassion, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

### **Awareness without judgment**

Allow whatever you are experiencing to rest in your awareness. Simply observe your experience as you *consider revealing what you believe through your actions. (Pause)* Give yourself permission to explore without judgment your feelings and thoughts, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

### **Inquiry: What is my body saying?**

Bring your attention to your body and notice what it is doing when you *consider revealing what you believe through your actions. (Pause)* Acknowledge any sensations you may feel. Observe and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

### **Talk to Jesus**

You might imagine that you are leaning back in the safe and loving arms of Jesus as together you *consider revealing what you believe through your actions*. Do you feel comfortable, uncomfortable, or do you feel nothing at all? Just observe. *(Pause)* Do you feel compelled to judge this revelation as good or bad? *(Pause)* Are you afraid of something? What story do you want to tell? *(Pause)* Observe your experience as just information. You might process with a long exhaling breath or the Dragon Breath.<sup>6</sup> *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

## Heal

God created human beings to have feelings about everything. You can choose to honor and observe your feelings without reacting to them. We all have to learn to experience our feelings and, at the same time, choose to live oriented lives. *(Pause)* The fact that you can step back and observe your experience lets you know that your experience does not define you; you are separate from your experience. *(Pause)* Breathe with compassion for everyone who is learning to deal with what is revealed by their actions. Help your body process with a long exhaling breath. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

*Optional:* Continue to breathe while I test for further integration.

Take a deep breath.

*(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the integration?")*

## 1:28 ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

We are grateful for this time to heal and train together. Hold us in the power of this new understanding as You continue to show us the truth about ourselves. Help us learn to trust You as we use our real resources to serve. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week as we co-labor with You to reorient our lives for a more effective flow and to flourish in our connection with our True Self and mission, with the Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.

*(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about this meeting?")*

## 1:29 ANNOUNCEMENTS

\*This is the time in our KF training cycle to consider whether we, as KF members, have the MATH to offer the next NHG book study to our wider community. All current members are invited to participate in offering this gift by signing up on the spreadsheet in the recent email sent from admin.

(\*Except when preparing for the Jubilee year)

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<sup>1</sup> [nutritiousmovement.com](http://nutritiousmovement.com).

<sup>2</sup> [www.centeringprayer.com](http://www.centeringprayer.com).

<sup>3</sup> Eph. 4:28.

<sup>4</sup> [en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tapas\\_Acupressure\\_Technique](http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tapas_Acupressure_Technique).

<sup>5</sup> James 1:17.

<sup>6</sup> See KF12.